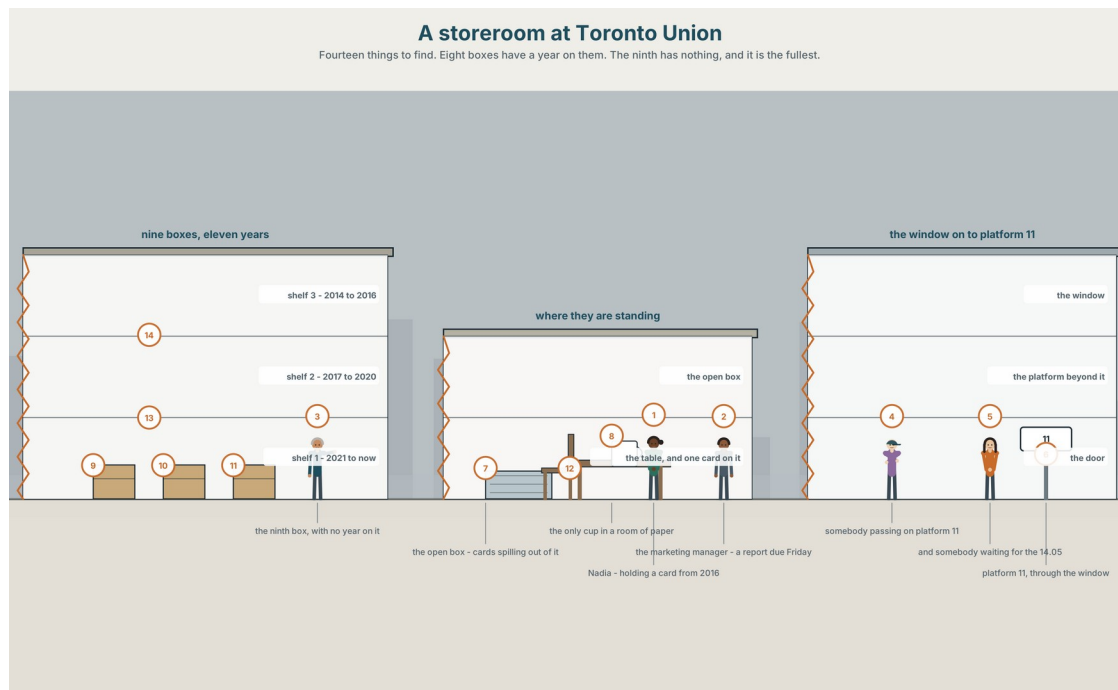


Table of Contents

A1.2 • Unit 10 • Four Thousand One Hundred Cards

English Animated • *Getting Around* • The Prairie Line, Toronto to Vancouver Student's Book
pages 204–225 • 22 pp • ~9 hours

Part 0 • The Big Picture ♦ A • THE WORLD



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6in}

A storeroom at Toronto Union — Fourteen things to find. Eight boxes have a year on them. The ninth has nothing, and it is the fullest.

What story do you tell twice?

By the end of this unit you can say what was the best, the worst and the strangest, and why it was too much or not enough.

♦ A • THE WORLD

♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Four thousand one hundred
handwritten cards that nobody has
ever read

superlative adjectives • *too* and
enough • 22 words for extremes and
opinions • which word to push, and
what the push means

◆ A • THE WORLD

Four thousand one hundred
handwritten cards that nobody has
ever read

◆ C • THE PERFORMANCE

You tell a two-minute story that
somebody else will retell

0A • Find it — fourteen things

Find these in the picture. Write the number.

☐ a box ☐ a card ☐ a shelf ☐ a window ☐ a door ☐ a light ☐ a pen ☐ a table ☐ a chair ☐ a bag ☐ a clock ☐ a label ☐ a year ☐ a platform

Three of these words are not in the picture. Which three?

a story • a memory • an ending

0B • Guess it

Look at the nine boxes. **Which one is the most recent?** Say one thing. You can use these words:

box • year • full • old • write

0C • Say it

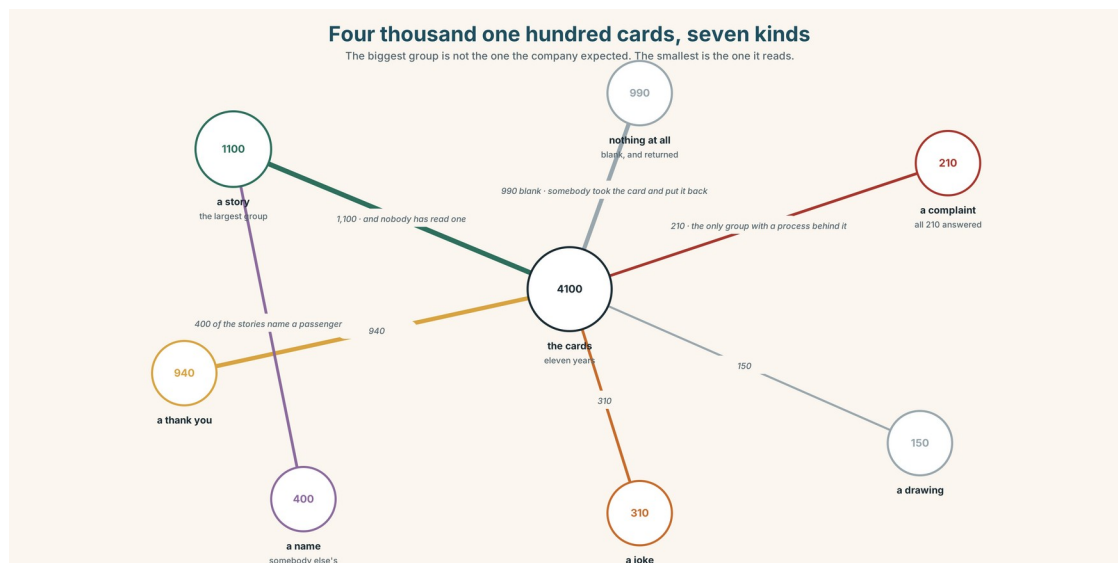
Record. Thirty seconds. Do not prepare.

Tell me a story you have told more than once. Any story.

You will listen to this again on the last page.

Part 1 • Vocabulary Lab 1 ◆ B • THE SYSTEM

1A • Meet — what people write on a card



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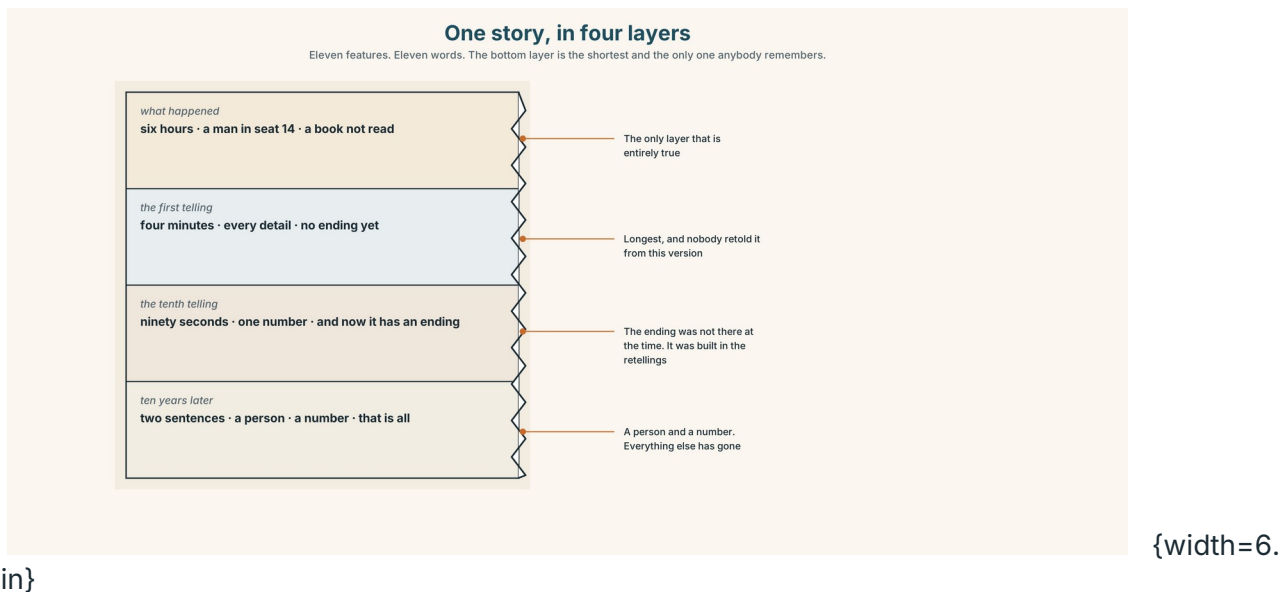
Four thousand one hundred cards, seven kinds — The biggest group is not the one the company expected. The smallest is the one it reads.

story	Eleven hundred of the four thousand one hundred.
memory	What a story is made of after about a year.
ending	The part people change when they tell it the second time.
true	What people claim and what nobody checks.
the best thing	The question on the card.
the worst part	The question nobody asked, and about four hundred people answered it anyway.

1B • Meet — the words

best • worst • longest • shortest • hardest • easiest • strangest • favourite • amazing • boring
• interesting • funny • true • story • memory • ending

Write each word under the right picture.



One story, in four layers — Eleven features. Eleven words. The bottom layer is the shortest and the only one anybody remembers.

1C • Sort — the thing, or your opinion of it?

Put each word in the right box. **Two of them can go in both. Which two, and why?**

story • boring • memory • amazing • ending • funny • interesting • true • favourite • longest

PART OF THE STORY	WHAT YOU THINK OF	
	IT	BOTH

1D • What people say about stories

the best thing	The question on the card, and the one everybody answers.
the worst part	Four hundred people wrote this without being asked.
a true story	Three words that are never said about a story that is only true.
at the end	Where the second telling changes.
turn out	The verb for an ending nobody predicted.
end up	The verb for being somewhere you did not plan to be.

Now say them. Two of these six are about where you finish and two are about what you thought. **Which is which, and which of the six is a warning?**

1E • Stretch — the phrases you will need today

the best thing · the worst part · a true story · turn out · end up

Match each phrase to the moment you need it.

1. You are about to tell something nobody will believe. → _____
2. Somebody asks you to sum up a week. → _____
3. The thing you were dreading was not the thing that went wrong. → _____
4. You went out for twenty minutes and came home at two. → _____
5. It was not what anybody expected, including you. → _____

1F • The hard one

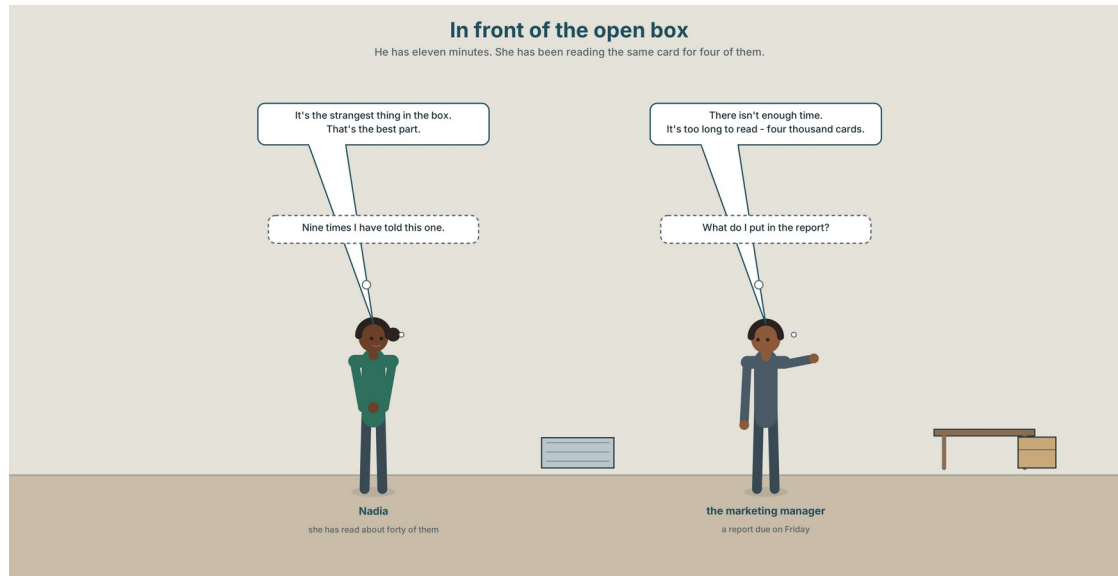
f That's the best part.

Practise it three times. **Four words that tell your listener the story is not over and the next sentence is the one.**

1G • Own it

Write down the best thing and the worst part of this course in one sentence each. Do not write your name. These will be read.

Part 2 • Listening ♦ A • THE WORLD



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6in}

In front of the open box — He has eleven minutes. She has been reading the same card for four of them.

2A • In the storeroom 📻 Track 10.1

Before you listen. There are four thousand one hundred cards and nobody has read them. **Guess:** what did most people write about?

Listen once. One question. How many boxes are there?

Listen again. Complete the table.

	What they expected	What is actually there
complaints		
stories		
nothing at all		

Listen again. True or false?

- Most of the cards are complaints. ☐ T ☐ F
- The newest box has no year on it. ☐ T ☐ F
- There is enough time to read them all. ☐ T ☐ F
- The company has read a sample. ☐ T ☐ F

Noticing. Four sentences from the recording.

- It's the strangest thing in the box.*
- That's the best part.*
- There isn't enough time.*
- It's too long to read.*

Sentences 3 and 4 both say there is a problem of amount. What is the difference between *too* and *not enough*?

2B • Decoding clinic 🎧 Track 10.2

Twenty seconds of Nadia at speed. Three jobs.

- 1. Count the superlatives you hear.
- 2. In one sentence she pushes the word *that*. In another she pushes *best*. What changes?
- 3. She says *the most amazing* and *the best*. Why is one two words and the other one?

Transcripts, page 157.

Part 3 • Grammar Lab 1 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

The end of the scale

3A • Notice

Look at the four sentences in Part 2 again.

- 1. In sentence 1, what is on the end of the adjective, and what is in front of it?
- 2. Why is *best* not *goodest*?
- 3. In sentence 3, what kind of word comes after *enough*?
- 4. In sentence 4, what is *too* saying about the amount?

3B • See

The same ruler, one mark further along
Short adjectives take -est. Long ones take the most. And every superlative takes the.

short	long → the longest	1 syllable · the + -est
	hard → the hardest	1 syllable · the + -est
	easy → the easiest	2 syllables in y · the + -iest
	amazing → the most amazing	3 syllables · the most
	interesting → the most interesting	4 syllables · the most
	good → the best	no rule · learn it
	bad → the worst	no rule · learn it
long		

6in} {width=6.

The same ruler, one mark further along — Short adjectives take -est. Long ones take the most. And every superlative takes the.

3C • Know

one syllable	the + -est	<i>the longest · the shortest · the hardest</i>
three or more	the most	<i>the most interesting ·</i>

the odd ones

no rule

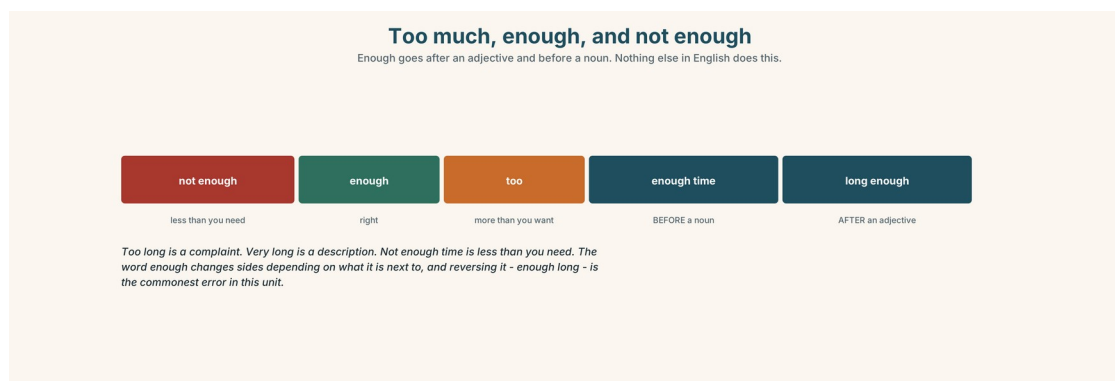
the most amazing
good → the best · bad
→ the worst · far → the
furthest

always the

one end, one thing

the strangest thing in
the box

Too and enough are not opposites. *Too* means more than you want. *Not enough* means less than you need. Both describe a mismatch, from opposite sides, and *enough* goes **after** an adjective and **before** a noun: *long enough, enough time*.



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6in}

Too much, enough, and not enough — Enough goes after an adjective and before a noun. Nothing else in English does this.

before a noun

enough time · enough cards · not
enough people

after an adjective

long enough · good enough · old
enough

too + adjective

too long · too expensive · too late

softening a superlative

one of the best · almost the longest ·
nearly the worst

Why it matters. Every opinion anybody gives about anything lands somewhere on this scale, and the two most common sentences in any review are *it was the best* and *it was too long*.

3D • Use — controlled

Complete with the superlative, **too** or **enough**.

It's (1) _____ (strange) thing in the box. That's (2) _____ (good) part. There isn't (3) _____ time to read them all. It's (4) _____ long — four thousand cards. It is (5) _____ (interesting) document the company owns and nobody has opened it.

3E • Use — guided

Make a superlative sentence, then say why with *too* or *enough*.

1. the longest journey you have made
2. the worst weather you have been out in

3. the most interesting place you have been
4. the hardest thing about English
5. the strangest thing you have kept

3F • Use — open

In pairs. Agree on the best, the worst and the strangest thing about this course. **You must agree on all three. Use *too* or *enough* at least twice.**

3G • Check — six items, mark your own

1. It's _____ thing in the box. (*two words — strange*)
2. That's _____ part. (*two words — good*)
3. There isn't _____ time.
4. It's _____ long to read.
5. × *It's the most strangest thing.* → correct it.
6. × *It isn't enough long.* → correct it.

The end of the scale, marked twice

✗ It's the most strangest thing.

the most

You met this exact error in Unit 3 as more cheaper. Strange is one syllable plus one, so it takes -est, and once it has taken it the word is already at the end of the scale. The most says the same thing again, and a scale has only one end.

✓ It's the strangest thing.

the

One superlative marker, chosen by the length of the adjective, and the in front of it every time. The is not optional: there is only one strangest thing in the box, and the says so.

What the writer thought:
 The most feels like an intensifier, the way more did. It is not. It is the superlative itself. The test is the same as in Unit 3: if the adjective has changed shape, do not put a word in front of it.

{width=6.

6in}

The end of the scale, marked twice — The end of the scale, marked twice

0–3 → Workbook pp. 40–43. **4–5** → Part 6. **6** → page 222.

Part 4 • Speaking ◆ C • THE PERFORMANCE

4A • Fluency starter — the superlative round

Everybody says one superlative about their week. **No adjective twice, and every sentence must have *the* in it.**

4B • The functional core — telling a story that gets retold

The same story, two cards
The left card has a number, a place and an ending. The right has three adjectives.

a number and an ending

seat 14 · six hours · 31 years · I didn't read my book

three adjectives

amazing · beautiful · wonderful — and 900 others like it

Find the six. One of the two was retold by somebody who was not there. Which, and what is in it that made that possible?

6 differences — find them all

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The same story, two cards — The left card has a number, a place and an ending. The right has three adjectives.

Language Bank

the extreme	the best · the worst · the strangest · the most amazing
the amount	too long · not enough time · long enough
the softening	one of the best · almost the longest
the story	a true story · at the end · it turned out that... · we ended up...

Information gap. Learner A has what the company expected to find on the cards. Learner B has what is actually on them. **Find the three biggest differences.**

4C • The performance — the story that gets retold

Tell a story in **two minutes** that your partner will have to retell to somebody else. You must:

use two superlatives · use *too* or *enough* once · have an ending nobody predicts · say one number

Your partner retells it in thirty seconds. **Record both.**

4D • Observer

One person listens for **one thing**: what survived into the retelling, and what did not?

4E • Two criteria

☐ Did my partner's retelling keep the ending? ☐ Did it keep the number?

Part 5 • Reading ♦ A • THE WORLD

5A • Predict

The title is "**Eleven hundred of them are stories.**" What were the cards supposed to collect?

5B • Read — sixty seconds

Eleven hundred of them are stories

For eleven years the company has put a card on every table in the dining car. It says: *The best thing about your journey?* and gives four lines.

Four thousand one hundred cards have come back. They are in nine boxes in a storeroom at Toronto Union. Nobody has read them.

The company expected complaints. It planned for complaints; there is a process for a complaint and a person whose job it is. There are two hundred and ten complaints in the boxes, and all two hundred and ten were answered, because they arrived by another route as well.

Eleven hundred of the cards are stories. People wrote about the person they sat next to. About nine hundred mention another passenger by description, and about four hundred mention one by name.

The company sells seats on a train. For eleven years its customers have been writing to it about each other.

5C • Answer

1. What does the card ask?
2. How many cards have come back?
3. How many of them are complaints?
4. How many mention another passenger by name?
5. **Why were all two hundred and ten complaints answered?**
6. **The last line says customers have been writing about each other. What does that suggest the company is actually selling?**

5D • Vocabulary in context

Guess from the text. Then check.

four lines • came back • by another route • by description • for eleven years

5E • The counter-text

One card, at full size
Four ruled lines were provided. The writing went up the side and over the address.

PRAIRIE LINE - COMMENT CARD

THE BEST THING ABOUT YOUR JOURNEY?

Lines provided	4
Lines used	4
Then continued	up the right margin
And then	across the back, over the address
Seat number box	14
Date	2016
Signed	first name only

WHAT IT IS ABOUT

A man the writer sat next to for two hours. He is described by his coat, by what he said about a bridge, and by the fact that he got off before the writer had finished asking him something.

The company's address is printed on the back. The writing goes over it, which means the card could not have been posted. It was left on the table.

— The question asks for the best thing about the journey

— Four lines. Somebody decided four lines was the right number

— And then two more surfaces

— A first name. They were not asking for anything

— Written over the address, so it was never going to be sent

{width=6.6in}

6in}

One card, at full size — Four ruled lines were provided. The writing went up the side and over the address.

Read the card and answer.

1. What is the printed question?
2. **How many lines were provided, and how much did this person write?**
3. What year is on it?
4. **The writing goes over the company's address. What does that tell you about who the writer thought they were writing to?**

5F • Two texts

The card asks for the best thing about the journey. Eleven hundred people wrote about another passenger.

Did they answer the question? Say one sentence.

Part 6 • Vocabulary Lab 2 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Too much, and not enough

One story, six lengths
At two minutes other people retell it. At half an hour nobody does.

1



30 seconds - not enough

2



90 seconds - and it travels

3



2 minutes - the best length

4



10 minutes - still good, not retold

5



half an hour - too long

6



and twice more - nobody is listening

{width=6.

6in}

One story, six lengths — At two minutes other people retell it. At half an hour nobody does.

6A • The ones that catch everybody

enough time

before a noun

long enough

after an adjective. This is the one everybody reverses

too / very

very long is a description; *too long* is a complaint

the most / the -est

the same rule as Unit 3, with *the* in front

6B • Say them

too • enough • most • least • very • so • absolutely • almost • nearly

6C • Chunk

1. There isn't _____ time. (*before a noun*)
2. It isn't long _____. (*after an adjective*)
3. It's _____ long. (*a complaint*)
4. It's _____ long. (*a description, not a complaint*)
5. It's _____ story I've heard. (*three words — amazing*)
6. _____ the longest. (*one word — not quite*)

6D • Contrast Clinic

Six items. **too** or **enough**?

1. It's _____ long — I stopped reading.
2. There isn't _____ time to read them all.
3. The card isn't big _____ .
4. It's _____ expensive for what it is.
5. Four lines isn't _____ .
6. It's _____ late to start now.

Part 7 • Pronunciation & Fluency Lab ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Which word you push

Which word you push
The same four words, five times. Each push answers a different question.

●	●	●	●	
THAT'S	the	best	part	not the other bit - this bit
●	●	●	●	
that's	THE	best	part	the one and only best part
●	●	●	●	
that's	the	BEST	part	not just good. Best
●	●	●	●	
that's	the	best	PART	and there is more of it coming
●	●	●	●	
It's	a	TRUE	sto-ry	you are defending it against doubt
●	●	●	●	
It's	a	true	STO-ry	a story, not a report

{width=6.

6in}

Which word you push — The same four words, five times. Each push answers a different question.

7A • Hear

That's the best part. — push **that's**: not the other bit, this bit push **best**: not just good — best push **part**: and there is more of it coming

7B • Say

Say the sentence five times, pushing a different word each time. Then say this:

It's not the longest story in the box — it's the strangest. — two pushes, and the second one is the point.

7C • Make it mean something

Say these two:

It's a TRUE story. — and you are defending it against doubt *It's a true STORY.* — and you are saying it is a story, not a report

Same four words. The push decides which word is being argued about. Which one would you say to somebody who did not believe you?

7D • Fluency 20

Twenty seconds: **six superlatives about this year, each with a reason.** Three times, faster.

Part 8 • Writing C • THE PERFORMANCE

A story on four lines • 50–70 words

8A • Read the model

The best thing was the man in seat 14. [the answer to the question, in nine words]

He got on at Winnipeg and he talked for six hours, and I had wanted to read. [the fact, and the honest resistance]

He had worked on this line for thirty-one years. He knew the name of every bridge. [the reason it turned out differently]

I didn't read any of my book. That is the best part. [the ending, and it contradicts the second line]

Questions about the writer's choices:

1. *I had wanted to read.* **Why admit resistance in a card about the best thing?**
2. *He knew the name of every bridge.* **Why that detail and not *he was interesting*?**
3. The last line repeats the phrase from the card. **What does that do?**

8B • The anti-model

The best thing was the scenery. It was amazing. The staff were very friendly and helpful. It was the most beautiful journey I have ever made. Thank you.

Correct English, entirely true, and there are nine hundred of these in the boxes and nobody can tell them apart. **Rewrite it with one person, one number and one thing that went wrong first.**

8C • Plan

the answer, short → the fact and your resistance → the detail that changed it → the ending, contradicting the second line

8D • Write — 50 to 70 words

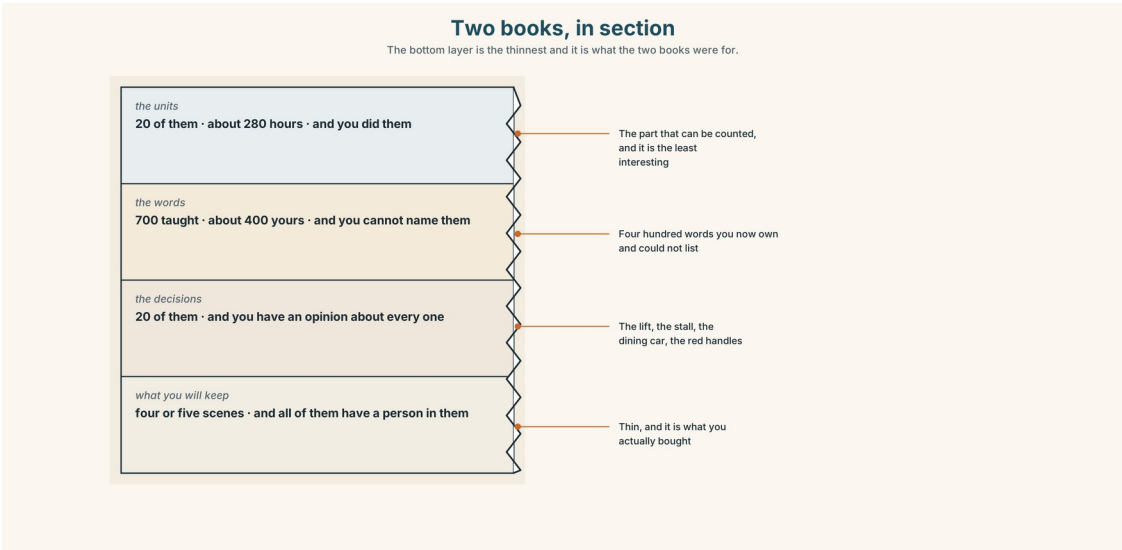
8E • Peer review — two things only

☐ Is there one number and one person in it? ☐ Could somebody retell it from memory tomorrow?

8F • Publish

On a card, on the wall, with no names. **The class reads them all and chooses three to keep. Then say what the three have in common.**

STUDY FILE • The story of this year



6in}

Two books, in section — The bottom layer is the thinnest and it is what the two books were for.

9A • What you will remember



6in}

Five recordings, one year — The fifth panel is the only one with a face in it.

What you were given	700 words, 20 units, about 280 hours
What you can measure	four recordings, made months apart

What you cannot	the moment you stopped translating, because nobody was there
What you keep	about five scenes, and all of them have a person in them

9B • Listen to all four

You recorded thirty seconds in A1.1 Unit 1, Unit 9 and Unit 10, and in Unit 6 of this book. **Play all four in order, now.** Write down three differences. Not *better*. **What.**

9C • Role play — the handover

In pairs. One of you is starting A1.1 tomorrow. The other has just finished A1.2. **Tell them the three things that are actually true about the next year.** No encouragement.

9D • The best part

Write one sentence beginning *The best thing about this year was...* **It must have a person or a number in it.** Those are the only two things that survive.

9E • Transfer — before A2.1

Record thirty seconds answering: *What can you do in English now?* Keep all five recordings together in one place. You will use them again at the end of A2.

Part 10 • Mediation & Interaction ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE



6in}

Four thousand one hundred cards — The last band is almost entirely empty, and that is the finding.

10A • Relay

Half the class has what the company expected. Half has what is in the boxes. **Build the real picture by speaking.** Ten minutes.

10B • Simplify — for one person

The marketing manager asks: *What is actually in those boxes?* **Answer in four sentences.** He has eleven minutes and a report due on Friday.

10C • Online

Write **one message** to a classmate about the best and worst thing in this course. **Three sentences.** Two superlatives and one *too* or *enough*.

10D • Your language

Does your language mark the end of a scale with an ending, or with a separate word? **Say the longest and the most interesting in your language.** Is it the same method for both?

Part 11 • The Decision ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

Four thousand one hundred cards

Nine boxes. Four thousand one hundred cards. Eleven years. Nobody has read them.

Option one: recycle them. They are eleven years old, the oldest are illegible, and nobody has missed them.

Option two: read a sample of four hundred and write a report. Costs about three weeks of one person's time and produces a document that will be read by six people.

Option three: type up the eleven hundred stories and put them on the website, with the writers' permission where there is a name. Costs about four months and nobody can say in advance what it is for.

11A • The evidence

The storeroom shelf, twice
As it is, and after the stories have been typed up.

as it is

9 boxes · closed · 0 read · 370 new cards a year



after

3 boxes · 1,100 typed · 1 screen · 900 new cards a year



Find the six. One of them is who is standing in front of it, and that is the one nobody forecast.

6 differences — find them all

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The storeroom shelf, twice — As it is, and after the stories have been typed up.

 **Track 10.6.** Nadia, 20 seconds: "I read about forty of them once, waiting for a train. The best one was from 2016 and it was about a man who talked for six hours. I have told that story about nine times. I have never told anybody what was in the report."

11B • Talk about it

In threes. Use the frame. Everybody says one.

I think the company should _____, because _____.

Words you can use: story · memory · best · worst · amazing · boring · true

11C • Decide

Write **two sentences**. Choose, and say why.

I think the company should _____, because _____.

11D • Model decision

Type up the eleven hundred stories. The report will tell the company what it already believes. The stories will tell it what it is selling, and it has been wrong about that for eleven years. Four months is nothing against eleven years of being wrong.

11E • The Reveal

What happened. The company typed up eleven hundred stories and put one a day on a screen in the dining car. Nothing measurable changed for six months.

Then something nobody expected: passengers began writing cards **about the cards on the screen**. The number of cards returned went from about three hundred and seventy a year to nine hundred, and the new ones were longer.

One question. You do not have to answer it out loud.

They had four thousand one hundred cards and no idea what to do with them. What had they been missing for eleven years?

Part 12 • Landing ♦ all three lines

12A • Recycle — twelve items

1. It's _____ thing in the box. (*two words — strange*)
2. That's _____ part. (*two words — good*)
3. There isn't _____ time.
4. It's _____ long to read.
5. It isn't long _____. (*after the adjective*)
6. It's _____ story I've heard. (*three words — amazing*)
7. _____ the longest. (*one word — not quite*)
8. It _____ that he had worked here for thirty-one years. (*two words*)
9. We _____ talking for six hours. (*two words — we did not plan to*)
10. It's _____. (*three words — and nobody checks*)
11. (*Unit 9*) It _____ snow. (*three words — look at the sky*)
12. (*Unit 8*) _____ you ever worked abroad?

12B • Consolidate — one task, everything in it

Write the story of this year in six sentences. Two superlatives, one *too*, one *enough*, one number, one person, and an ending that contradicts the beginning.

12C • Can-do, with evidence

- ☐ I can say what was the best, the worst and the strangest. **Evidence:** 4C, 8D ☐ I can form superlatives correctly. **Evidence:** 3G ☐ I can use *too* and *enough* in the right place. **Evidence:** 6D ☐ I can push the right word in a sentence. **Evidence:** 7C

12D • Replay

Record 0C again. **Then listen to all five recordings from both books, in order. One year. Five recordings.** What is different?

12E • Glossary — thirty-five words, as a map

THE ENDS OF SCALES • best • worst • longest • shortest • hardest • easiest • strangest **WHAT YOU THINK** • favourite • amazing • boring • interesting • funny • true **THE PARTS** • story • memory • ending • the best thing • the worst part • at the end **WHAT HAPPENS** • turn out • end up • a true story **AMOUNT** • too • enough • most • least • very • so • absolutely • almost • nearly **SAYING IT** • the most beautiful • not enough time • It's too long. • That's the best part.

12F • Next

A2.1 • Making Plans • Unit 1 • How long have you been at this?